

PersianPulse

MYTH CHECK

Plant omega-3 vs fish omega-3

Same family, different jobs

THE MYTH

~~Plant omega-3 does the same job as fish omega-3.~~

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SAYS

The body converts only a small share of plant ALA into the EPA and DHA found in fish. NIH says eating EPA and DHA directly is the only practical way to raise their levels.

< 15%

Reported conversion of ALA to EPA and DHA

1.6 | 1.1 g

ALA Adequate Intake per day, men | women (age 19 to 50)

STILL USEFUL

Flaxseed oil, chia seeds and walnuts supply ALA, and ALA counts toward the ALA Adequate Intake.

> **Plant foods supply ALA. Fish supplies EPA and DHA. They are not interchangeable.**

Sources: NIH Office of Dietary Supplements

Photo: Vie Studio · Pexels · Educational content, not medical advice.

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